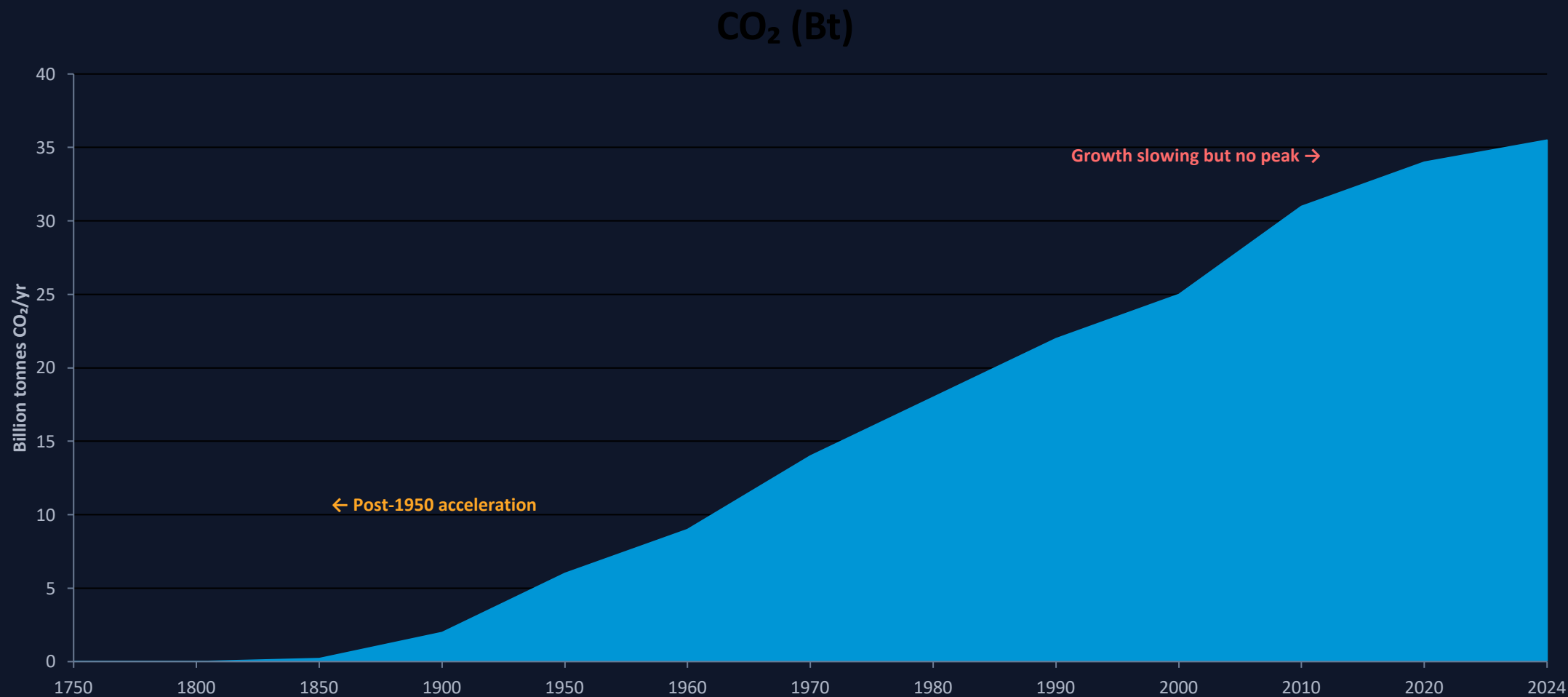

Global CO₂ Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Fossil fuels & industry · 1750–2024

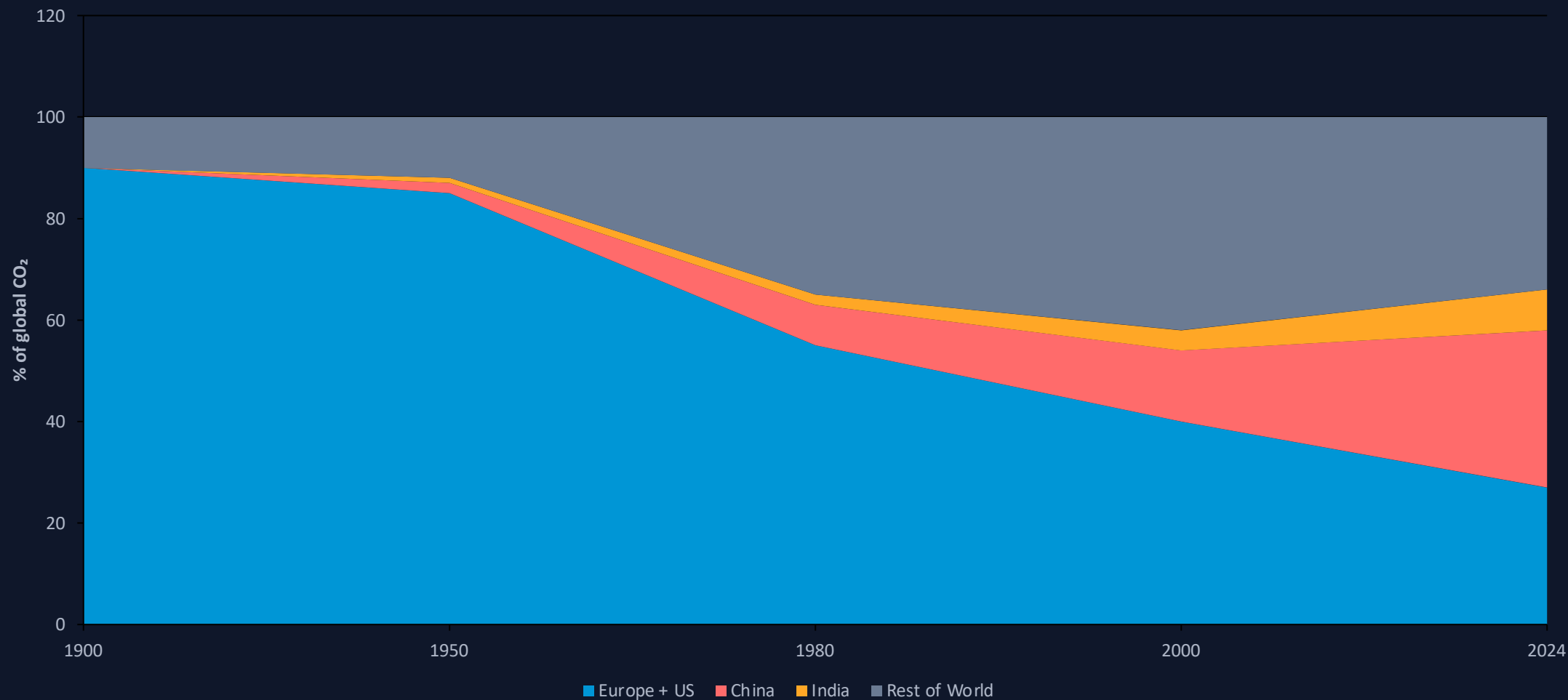
Data: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

For policy analysts, climate negotiators, and sustainability researchers

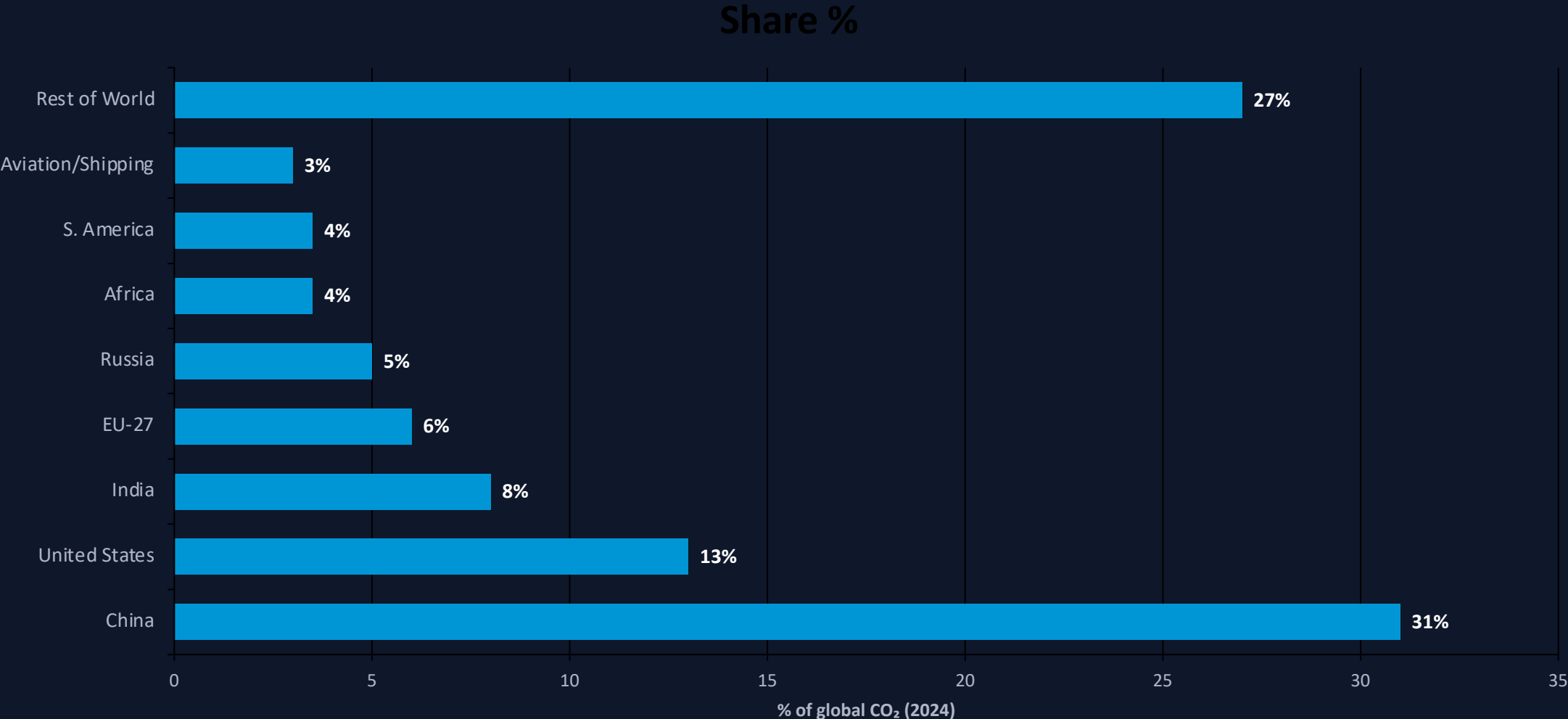
Global CO₂ Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today



Europe & the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under ⅓ Today



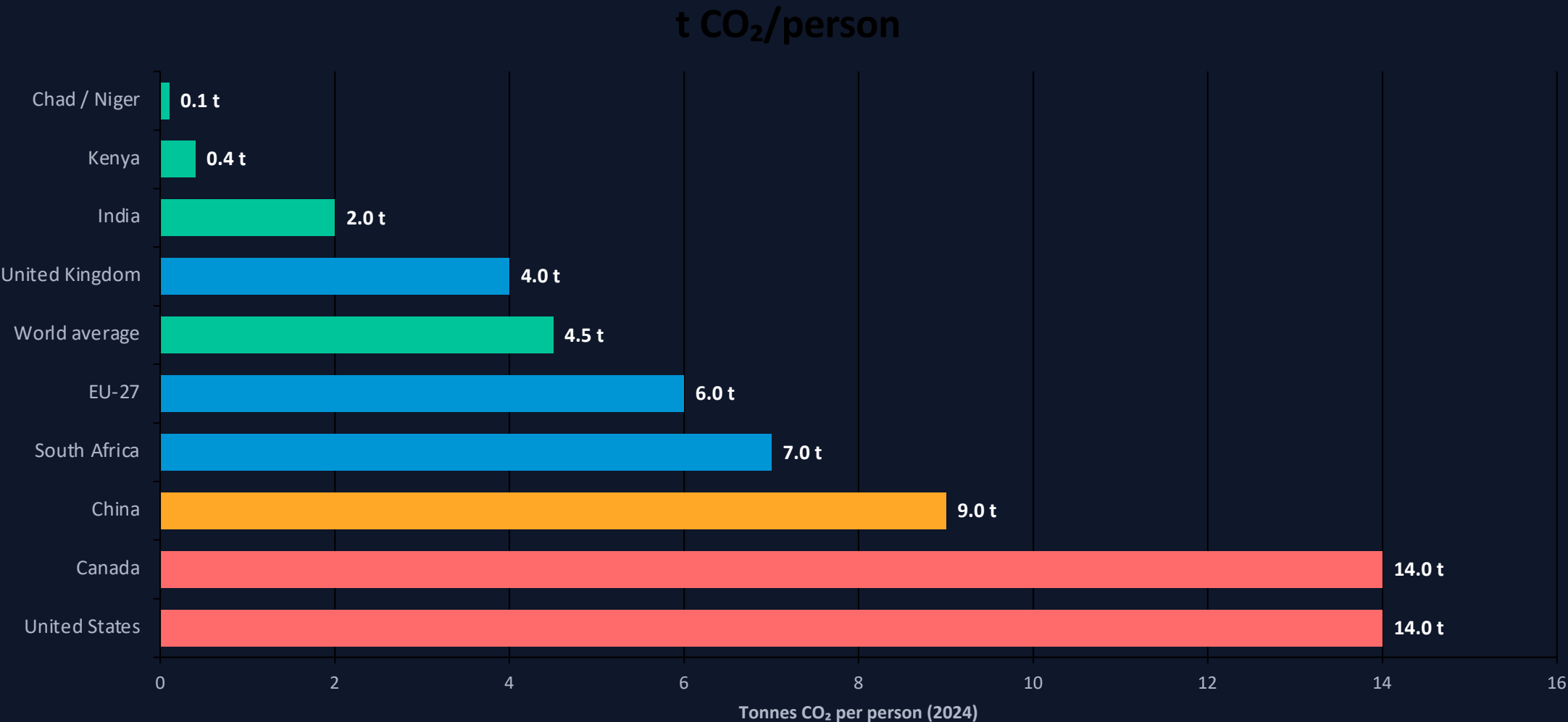
China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO₂



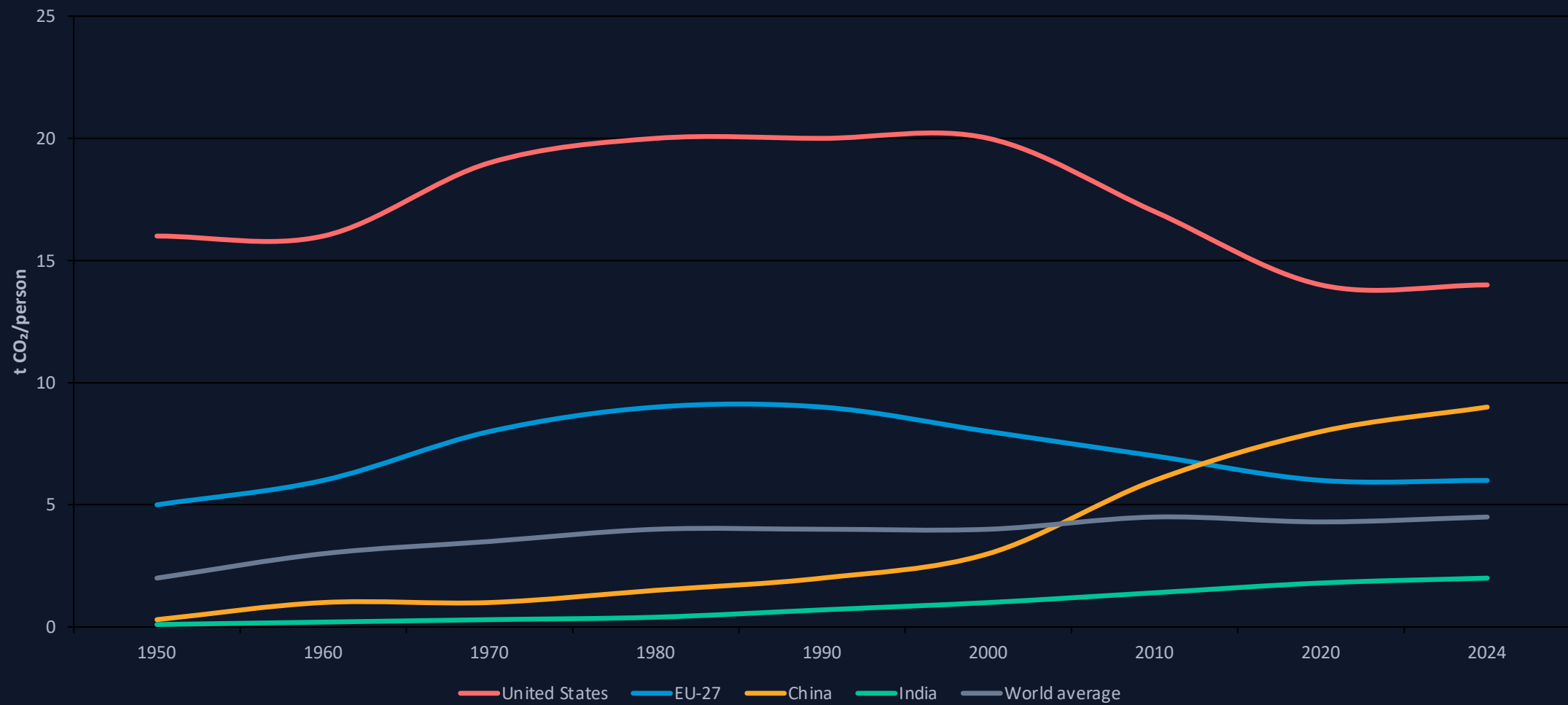
Trend: China rising (growth slowing) · US declining · India rising · EU declining

Per Capita Emissions: 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US & Canada

A 150× gap between the lowest and highest large-country emitters

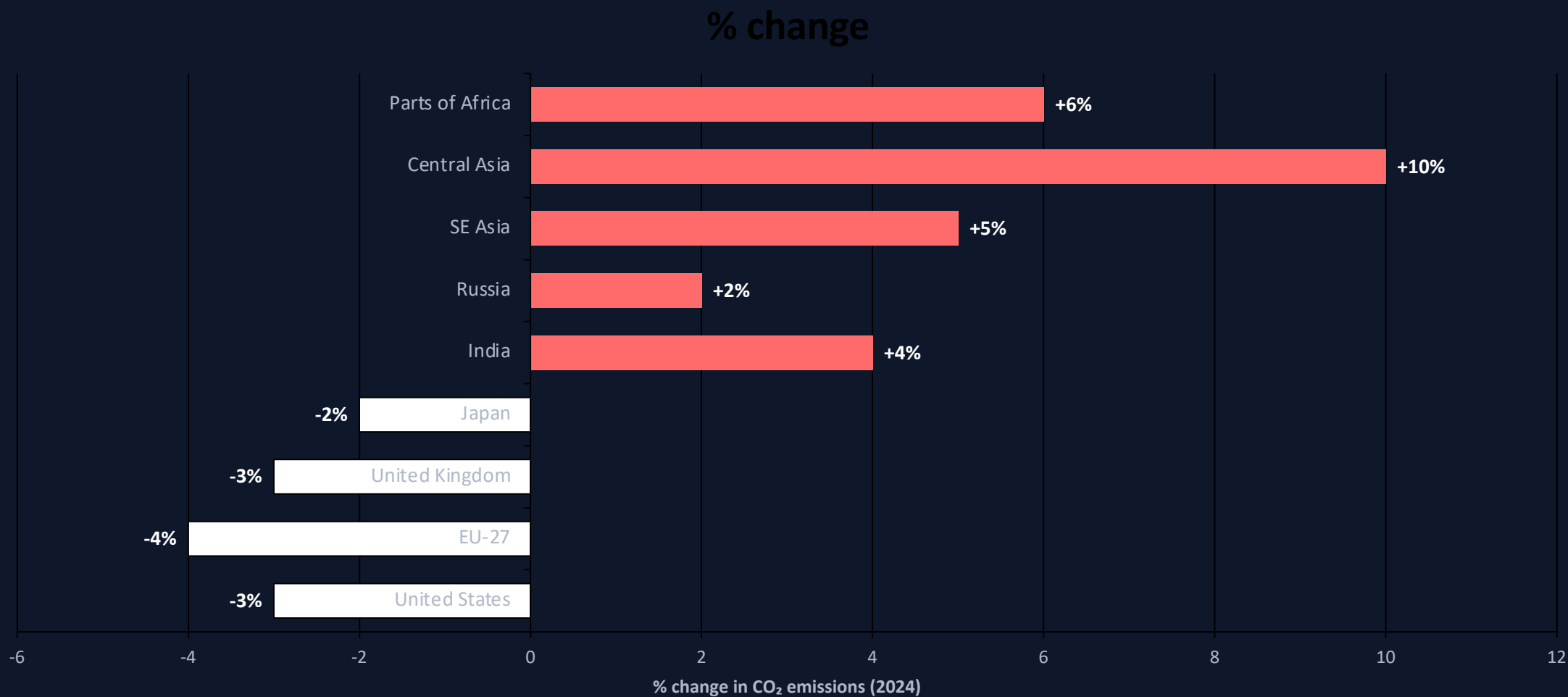


Per Capita: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2 t in India



China's per capita is still below the US despite being the largest total emitter

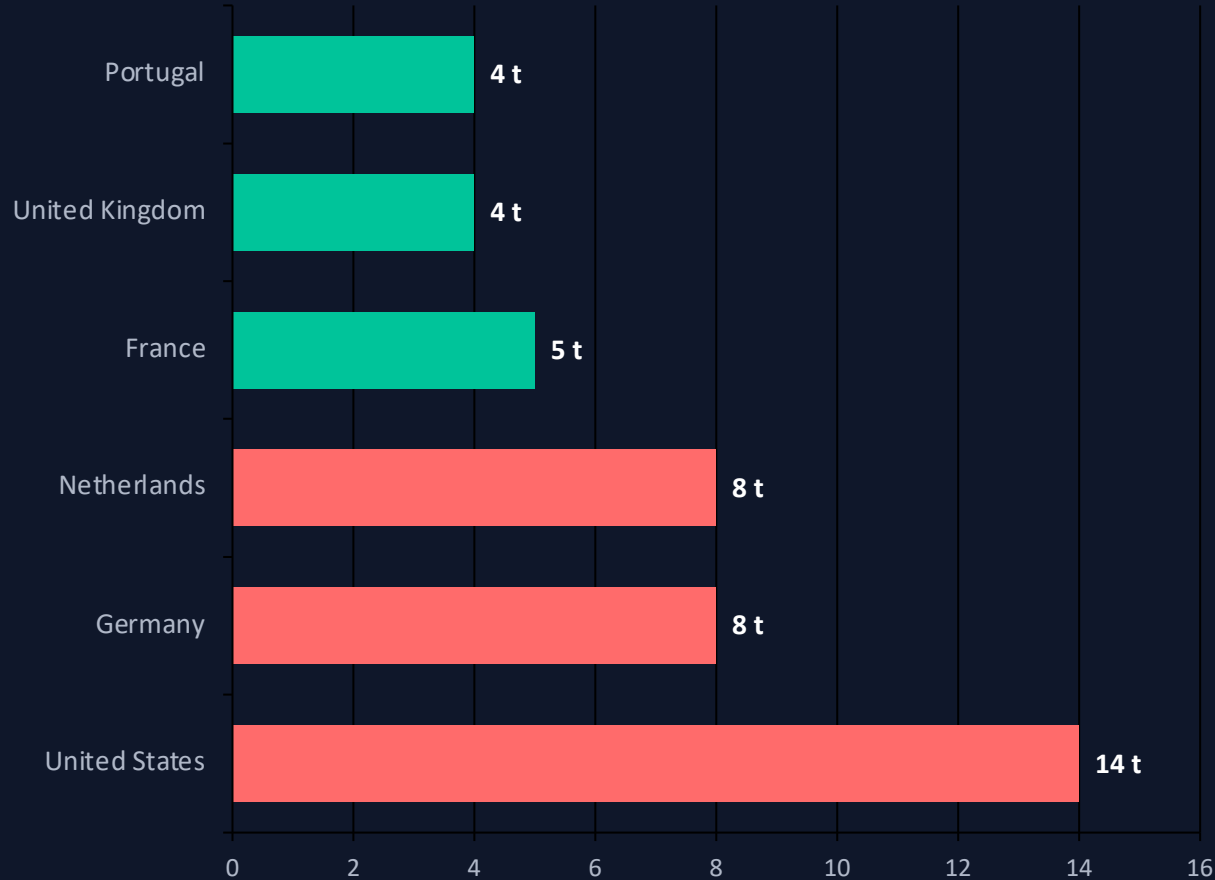
2024: Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia & Africa Grew



Blue = decline · Red = increase · Central Asia (e.g. Turkmenistan) saw increases >10%

Energy Mix Explains Why France & the UK Emit Far Less Than Germany or the US

t CO₂/person



Similar prosperity, very different emissions

Red bars: High fossil fuel dependence

- US, Germany, Netherlands rely heavily on coal, oil, and natural gas

Green bars: Cleaner energy mix

- France: ~70% nuclear electricity
- UK: rapid shift to wind + gas
- Portugal: strong renewables base

Energy policy choices — not wealth — drive per capita emission differences among developed nations.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal



No peak yet — Global CO₂ emissions exceed 35 Bt/yr and continue to rise, despite slowing growth.



China is the largest annual emitter (~31%) but its per capita emissions (~9 t) remain below the US (~14 t).



Historical responsibility is dominated by Europe and the US, which produced >90% of emissions in 1900.



A 150× per capita gap persists between the poorest nations (~0.1 t) and the wealthiest (~14 t).



Energy policy matters — countries with similar prosperity can have very different emissions depending on their energy mix.